

Doe v. St. Aurelius Health System

CryptVault ransomware breach · HHS OCR investigation and class action

PLATFORM

Casepoint

DOCUMENTS

400 · 282 emails, 33 memos, 85 files

DATE RANGE

January 21, 2025 – June 28, 2025

Training matter. The parties, events and documents are fictional and exist for AA Team review practice.

1 Matter overview

A CryptVault ransomware attack on St. Aurelius Health System exposed approximately 2.1 million patient records. The HHS Office for Civil Rights is investigating under HIPAA, and patients have filed a class action. We are reviewing St. Aurelius's documents for production.

This matter is redaction-heavy. Patient and employee information must come out before anything is produced, and the click-to-redact tool is part of the exercise.

2 Parties and custodians

ROLE	NAME
CEO	Robert Ellison
CISO	Priya Raman
General Counsel	Diane Okafor
IT Director	Marcus Webb
Finance Director	Tom Okonkwo
Also collected	HR and the Patient Privacy Office

3 Coding fields on Casepoint

These are the values the coding panel offers. Every document gets all five fields, and all five are graded.

FIELD	VALUES
Responsiveness	Responsive · Not Responsive · Technical Issue
Privilege	Not Privileged · Privileged · Redact (Privilege)
Issues	Select every issue that applies
Production	Produce · Withhold · Redact
Confidentiality	Confidential · Highly Conf. – AEO

4 How to code

IF THE DOCUMENT IS...	RESPONSIVENESS	PRIVILEGE	PRODUCTION	CONFIDENTIALITY
A file that failed processing and cannot be read	Technical Issue	Not Privileged	Withhold	Confidential
Not responsive to any request	Not Responsive	Not Privileged	Withhold	Confidential
Responsive and privileged throughout	Responsive	Privileged	Withhold	See 8
Responsive, with a privileged passage inside ordinary business content	Responsive	Redact (Privilege)	Redact	Confidential
Responsive, not privileged, but contains protected personal or sensitive information (see 9)	Responsive	Not Privileged	Redact	By content (see 8)
Responsive, and none of the above	Responsive	Not Privileged	Produce	See 8

- Production means "does this go out". A document that is not responsive, or cannot be read, is withheld. It is the same rule on every platform in the AA Team program.
- Technical Issue: if a file failed processing, code it Technical Issue, withhold it and route it for re-collection. Never guess substantive coding for a document you cannot read.
- Issues go on responsive documents only. Hot Doc is tagged alongside the substantive issues, never instead of them.

5 Issue tags

#	ISSUE	DEFINITION	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
1	Security Failures	The control gaps that let the attackers in.	Patching, MFA, network segmentation, known vulnerabilities left open.
2	Timeline & Notification	When the breach was found, and when patients and HHS were told.	Discovery dates, notification decisions, patient complaints about notice.
3	Incident Response	What St. Aurelius did once it knew.	Containment, forensics, ransom negotiation, recovery, staffing, cost.
4	Hot Doc	Documents especially damaging to St. Aurelius.	Tag alongside the substantive issues.

6 Attorney and law-firm screen

A name on this list does not make a document privileged. It tells you to read closely for legal advice.

NAME	ROLE	FIRM / DOMAIN
Diane Okafor	General Counsel, St. Aurelius	In-house
Whitmore Gray	Outside counsel	whitmoregray.com
Sentinel Forensics	Forensic firm retained BY outside counsel	sentinelforensics.com

7 Privilege

- Privileged means legal advice from General Counsel Diane Okafor or from outside counsel at Whitmore Gray.
- Communications with the threat actor, including the ransom negotiation, are never privileged.

8 Confidentiality

DESIGNATION	USE IT FOR
Highly Conf. – AEO	Sensitive business information: internal discussion of financial exposure, costs and insurance, and the ransom terms. Among privileged documents: forensic work performed at outside counsel's direction.
Confidential	Everything else: patient complaints and HR records once redacted, security correspondence, notification logistics, incident-response status updates, vendor invoices, PR material, other privileged communications, and every Not Responsive and Technical Issue document.

These categories come from how the matter is graded. The call follows the content, not who sent the document.

9 Redaction

- PII: Social Security numbers, home addresses, dates of birth.
- PHI: medical details, diagnoses and treatment information.
- SBI (sensitive business information): cost estimates, insurance posture, ransom terms.
- Not protected, so leave them visible: job titles and department names.
- Redact, then produce: Production is Redact and Privilege stays Not Privileged. Designate Highly Conf. – AEO when the redacted content is sensitive business information; otherwise Confidential.

10 Matter alerts

Who directed the forensics decides privilege

Forensic work performed by Sentinel Forensics at outside counsel's direction, in anticipation of litigation, is protected work product (the Kovel line of cases). The same technical content prepared without counsel's direction is not protected. Before you code a forensic document, check who retained and directed the work.

11 Escalation and the QC standard

STEP	WHO	WHEN
1	Glory or Junior	Your first go-to for every question.
2	Zabron or Simon	If Glory and Junior are unavailable or need backup.
3	Aaron	If it is still unclear after steps 1 and 2.
4	PM / RM	If Aaron has no clear answer, or the question is client-level.

- Never guess silently on a gray area. While you wait for an answer, protect the document: treat it as privileged and do not release it.
- Ask a good question: the document ID; short context (who is writing to whom, about what); your lean and why; and what makes it difficult.

QC TRACK STANDARD	
Accuracy	Measured as defects per 1,000 documents. The target is zero. One defect per thousand still scores 95.
Pace	60 documents per hour, sustained, done properly.
Responsiveness	Reply to supervisor messages within 2 minutes while on shift.
The rule that outranks the others	Never trade privilege accuracy for speed.